

SOC L1 Alert Reporting

Portfolio Evidence & Learning Summary



The screenshot displays the TryHackMe interface for the 'SOC L1 Alert Reporting' room. At the top, the room title is followed by a description: 'Learn how to properly report, escalate, and communicate about high-risk SOC alerts.' Below this, a green bar indicates 'Room completed: 100%'. A navigation bar contains buttons for 'Share your achievement', 'Save Room', '907 Recommend', 'Connectivity', and 'Options'. A list of six tasks is shown, each with a green checkmark indicating completion: Task 1 Introduction, Task 2 Alert Funnel, Task 3 Reporting Guide, Task 4 Escalation Guide, Task 5 SOC Communication, and Task 6 Conclusion.

SOC L1 Alert Reporting
Learn how to properly report, escalate, and communicate about high-risk SOC alerts.

60 min 90,268

Share your achievement Save Room 907 Recommend Connectivity Options

Room completed: 100%

- Task 1 ✓ Introduction
- Task 2 ✓ Alert Funnel
- Task 3 ✓ Reporting Guide
- Task 4 ✓ Escalation Guide
- Task 5 ✓ SOC Communication
- Task 6 ✓ Conclusion

Evidence captured from the completed TryHackMe room. The screenshot shows "Room completed: 100%" and the six completed tasks: Introduction, Alert Funnel, Reporting Guide, Escalation Guide, SOC Communication, and Conclusion.

Platform: TryHackMe **Room:** SOC L1 Alert Reporting **Focus:** SOC alert documentation, escalation and communication

1. Executive Summary

This portfolio entry documents completion of the TryHackMe **SOC L1 Alert Reporting** room. The exercise focuses on what happens after an L1 analyst investigates an alert: recording useful findings, deciding when escalation is appropriate, and communicating clearly with L2 analysts and other teams. TryHackMe describes the room as covering alert reporting, escalation and communication as core L1 SOC skills.

The completed-room evidence demonstrates exposure to the complete learning sequence, including the alert funnel, structured reporting, escalation procedures and communication scenarios. This is relevant to entry-level SOC analyst work because investigation results must be understandable and actionable for the next analyst or stakeholder.

2. Learning Objectives

- Understand the need for SOC alert reporting and escalation.
- Learn how to write alert comments or case reports properly.
- Explore escalation methods and communication best practices.
- Apply the knowledge to triage alerts in a simulated environment.
- Build confidence for SOC Simulator activities and the Security Analyst Level 1 (SAL1) pathway.

3. Prerequisites & Context

The room lists the preceding **SOC L1 Alert Triage** room as a prerequisite, along with basic knowledge of common attacks and the responsibilities of SOC L1 analysts. The reporting room therefore extends the workflow from initial alert investigation into documentation, escalation and communication.

4. SOC L1 Workflow Learned

Stage	Portfolio takeaway
1. Receive alert	Alerts can arrive through SIEM, EDR or a ticketing platform.
2. Investigate / triage	Determine what happened, affected entities, timing and relevant evidence.
3. Classify	Decide whether the alert is a True Positive or False Positive based on evidence.
4. Report	Document the investigation so another analyst can understand the case without starting over.
5. Escalate	Send cases requiring deeper investigation, remediation or senior support to L2.
6. Communicate	Coordinate with L2, IT, HR, management or other stakeholders when appropriate.

5. Reporting Method: The Five Ws

The room recommends using a Five Ws structure to make reports useful to L2, DFIR and other professionals. A strong report should answer:

Who	Which user, account or actor was involved?
What	What exact action or sequence of events occurred?
When	When did the suspicious activity start and end?
Where	Which host, IP, device, website or other asset was involved?

Why

What evidence and reasoning support the final verdict?

Portfolio interpretation: The Five Ws approach turns raw investigation data into a repeatable case narrative. It also makes handover easier because the next analyst can quickly identify the affected user, activity, time window, systems involved and the reasoning behind the classification.

6. Escalation Criteria

- A major cyberattack or activity requiring deeper investigation / DFIR.
- Remediation such as malware removal, host isolation or password reset.
- Communication with customers, partners, management or law enforcement.
- Situations where the L1 analyst does not fully understand the alert and needs senior support.

Escalation sequence practiced conceptually

- Move the alert to In Progress and perform the analysis.
- Write the alert report and record the verdict, such as True Positive.
- If escalation is required, assign the alert to the L2 analyst on shift.
- L2 receives the notification and uses the report as the starting context for deeper analysis.

7. Communication Scenarios

Scenario	Expected response
Urgent alert; L2 unavailable	Use the emergency contact process: try L2, then L3, then the manager.
Possible account compromise	Use an alternative communication channel rather than the potentially compromised chat account.
Alert surge	Prioritise according to workflow and inform the L2 analyst on shift.
Later discovery of misclassification	Immediately notify L2 and explain the concern; do not silently leave the error unreported.
SIEM parsing/search problem	Investigate what is possible and report the tooling/data-quality issue to L2 or the SOC engineer.

8. Portfolio-Ready Alert Report Template

The following template can be reused for future SOC lab exercises. It reflects the reporting principles covered in the room without claiming that the fields below describe a real incident.

Field	What to record
Alert / Case ID	Unique alert or ticket identifier
Severity	Assigned severity and reason
Verdict	True Positive / False Positive / other team-approved classification
Who	User, account, process or actor involved
What	Observed action(s) and relevant event sequence
When	Start/end timestamps and timezone
Where	Hostname, IP, URL, application or other affected asset
Evidence	Relevant logs, alerts, process names, hashes, URLs, screenshots or other IOCs
Why	Evidence-based reasoning supporting the verdict
Impact	Known or suspected effect on the environment
Actions taken	Investigation and containment/remediation steps already performed
Escalation	Whether L2/another team was engaged and why
Next steps	Recommended follow-up for the receiving analyst/team

9. Skills Demonstrated

- SOC alert lifecycle understanding
- L1 alert triage and classification concepts
- Evidence-based case documentation
- Five Ws reporting
- L1-to-L2 escalation workflow
- Security operations communication
- Incident handover and context preservation
- Awareness of DFIR and remediation handoffs

10. Portfolio Reflection

This exercise strengthened my understanding that SOC analysis is not only about detecting suspicious activity. A useful investigation must also be documented in a way that another analyst can understand, validate and act on. The room reinforced the importance of concise evidence-based reporting, appropriate escalation and clear communication during uncertain or high-impact situations.

For future labs, I will apply the Five Ws to structure investigation notes, preserve the evidence and reasoning behind each verdict, and explicitly record escalation requirements and next steps.

11. Evidence & Sources

Primary learning source: TryHackMe — SOC L1 Alert Reporting. The official room covers the alert funnel, reporting guide, escalation guide, SOC communication and conclusion. The screenshot included in this document shows the room at 100% completion.

Additional reference: TryHackMe SOC Simulator documentation explains assigning alerts, writing case reports, selecting True Positive / False Positive, escalating alerts and completing scenarios.

Official resources: tryhackme.com/room/socl1alertreporting and tryhackme.com/soc-sim

Portfolio note: This document is a learning record based on a simulated training environment. It should not be presented as evidence of handling a real-world security incident unless supported by separate professional experience.